

TAB 22



Board of Education Report

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Agenda Date: 4/21/2026

In Control: Board of Education

Ms. Gonez, Mr. Melvoin, Ms. Griego - Learning Begins at Birth: Growing LAUSD Early Learning Programs (Res-049-25/26) (Noticed March 10, 2026)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District (LAUSD) is committed to serving the needs of its youngest learners and strengthening engagement with families through high quality, accessible, early education programs for children ages 0-4 and as of the 2025-2026 school year LAUSD serves a total of 14,228 students in Transitional Kindergarten and 10,671 children in our Early Education Centers, California State Pre-School Program and Infant Centers;

Whereas, LAUSD has taken significant steps to expand access to early childhood education for young learners, including increasing enrollment in early education centers for 2 to 4 year olds and making changes such as removing potty training requirements in accordance with state law and opening enrollment beyond traditional income limits, resulting in a more inclusive, accessible preschool system for families in Los Angeles ([LAist, May 2025](https://laist.com/news/education/early-childhood-education-pre-k/lausd-preschool-enrollment-up-policy-change-toilet-training-income)) <<https://laist.com/news/education/early-childhood-education-pre-k/lausd-preschool-enrollment-up-policy-change-toilet-training-income>>;

Whereas, Early childhood education programs have been shown to improve school readiness and long term academic success for all children, particularly those from historically underserved communities, including low-income families, multilingual learners, and children with disabilities, and a high-quality preschool experience has been linked to lasting advantages such as higher educational attainment including graduation rates, significant reductions in special education placement as well as better long-term health outcomes, and lower crime rates ([McCoy et al. 2017](https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/30147124/)) <<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/30147124/>>;

Whereas, Early childhood education is frequently a family's first interaction with LAUSD, introducing families to District schools, serving as powerful tools for building trust, strengthening enrollment pipelines, promoting school readiness, and supporting long-term community engagement with District schools;

Whereas, Even as options for four-years-olds have increased (such as through universal transitional kindergarten) and capacity to serve three-year-olds has grown, access to infant and toddler programs remain limited in many parts of Los Angeles, creating barriers for working families, particularly those who rely on affordable care;

Whereas, In California the average cost of infant and toddler care is approximately \$21,945 per year, placing significant burden on families and limiting access to early care for many working households, and in Los Angeles County, only 18 percent of children eligible for subsidized childcare are enrolled, underscoring a substantial gap between need and access to affordable early care and education programs;

Whereas, Access to infant and toddler care is critical to family economic stability, as the lack of affordable and available childcare forces many parents especially mothers, out of the workforce, with a significant share citing inability to find care as the primary reason for leaving employment;

Whereas, These affordability and access gaps create an urgent need to expand publicly supported infant and toddler care programs, particularly in communities with the highest unmet need, and position local public institutions, including school districts as key partners in increasing access to early learning opportunities;

Whereas, LAUSD maintains an inventory of facilities that could potentially host additional infant centers and early childhood education programs, yet greater coordination is needed to prioritize expansion in communities with the highest need;

Whereas, Partnerships with early childcare providers help meet our family's unique needs, expand access, and create enrollment pipelines into LAUSD schools, these partnerships would benefit from clear protocols and alignment with District priorities;

Whereas, Dual language early education programs promote bilingualism, biliteracy, academic achievement, and cultural affirmation, yet access remains limited and there is no clear picture of the community demand for programs;

Whereas, The expansion of early learning sites including infant centers and dual **language immersion** programs in high need communities plays a critical role in closing literacy and numeracy gaps, strengthening school readiness and improving long term academic outcomes for students; and

Whereas, The earliest years of life represent a critical period of brain development, during which the foundation for language, literacy, and social-emotional development is established, and families and caregivers are not only a child's first teachers, but essential partners in shaping lifelong learning and wellbeing;

Whereas, Most infants and toddlers are cared for by a parent or in home-based settings, highlighting that improving early outcomes requires direct support, trust-building, and sustained investment in parents and caregivers as leaders in their children's development;

Whereas, Cross-sector efforts between LAUSD and community partners to reach and support families starting at birth have demonstrated the importance of early and proactive engagement with families to build trust, strengthen relationships, and provide culturally and linguistically responsive supports that advance early literacy and long-term educational success; and

Whereas, A strategic and coordinated approach to our early **childhood** education program expansion is necessary to ensure that equity focused program growth simultaneously advances both student success and District enrollment goals; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District recognizes the essential role of early childhood education to the wellbeing of our children, families and communities, and commits to leveraging its programs and partnerships to expand access to affordable, high-quality early learning opportunities in Los Angeles;

Resolved further, That the Los Angeles Unified School District shall develop a plan to for strategically increasing access to and availability of early childhood education programs by opening new infant centers and early education centers, increasing dual immersion programs and exploring partnerships with external early education providers prioritizing areas that have demand and lack availability;

Resolved further, That the proposed Early Childhood Education Expansion plan shall include recommendations and considerations for the:

- Reopening of shuttered early education centers and/or opening of new early education centers and/or state preschool programs on elementary campuses, based on unmet community needs and prioritizing access for low-income families;
- Expanding Expansion of infant center programs for children age 0-2, to ensure each board district has an open center by 2028. ensuring at least one program in each board district by 2028, prioritizing center expansion and family enrollment based on greatest need;
- Expansion of ~~D~~ dual language early education programs ~~expansion~~ at Early Education Centers and, additionally, in transitional kindergarten (TK) and/or California State Preschool Programs (CSPP) at elementary schools, such so that every elementary school with a dual-language program has ~~is connected to~~ a feeder preschool dual-language program, while considering teacher recruitment, training, ~~and~~ credentialing and strategies for program sustainability and expansion;
- Increased and coordinated partnerships with family home providers (including shared professional development opportunities, increased communication, articulation agreements, intercession and before/after school care for TK and CSPP students), aligned with LAUSD Early Education Strategic Plan goals;
- A review of existing external early education providers operating on District facilities to ensure alignment with our programs and assess opportunities for continued or expanded partnership;
- Use of underutilized district spaces by external providers by community-based organizations to provide expanded infant/ toddler opportunities and services for current and future LAUSD families, where District programs currently do not exist;

Resolved further, That for each item above, the plan shall ~~consider expected demand and communities without an existing program, current use of sites, required facilities upgrades, operational costs, available funding sources, staffing, and strategic opportunities to co-locate with adult school campuses that provide workforce training pathways for adult students, incorporating these considerations into the recommendations for the Board's consideration.~~

evaluate and incorporate considerations for the following:

- Current and projected demand by community/neighborhood
- Use of underutilized building/sites
- Required facilities upgrades, including budget estimates, operational impacts, and anticipated timelines
- Operational costs
- Available funding sources
- Staffing availability and requirements
- Regulatory implications (e.g. State authorized capacity, licensing requirements)
- Strategic opportunities to co-locate with adult school campuses that provide workforce training

pathways for adult students;

Resolved further, That the District shall explore the development of a Childcare and Early Education Career Technical Education (CTE) pathway in high-need communities to support high school students, both during high school and post-graduation, in obtaining the necessary credentials and meeting the professional requirements within the childcare and early education field, including, but not limited pathways to the childcare provider license and Early Childhood Education Teacher or Teacher Assistant credentials;

~~Resolved further, That the District shall create an inventory of community-based providers and include in the plan strategies for enhanced partnerships with existing external providers, aligned with LAUSD early education goals. Such strategies shall include shared professional development opportunities, increased communication, articulation agreements, and an analysis of potential partnerships with family home providers to support early education students during intersession and before/after school and whether underutilized district spaces could be utilized by community-based organizations to provide expanded early education opportunities and services for current and future LAUSD families; and be it finally,~~

Resolved further, That, as it expands programs, the District shall continue developing a family-centered approach to reach and support families beginning at birth, including strengthening its family engagement, potential partnerships with healthcare and community-based organizations, and distributing culturally and linguistically responsive resources that equip parents, caregivers, and those providing home-based childcare, to support children's development during the earliest years of life, and, be it finally,

Resolved, That the District will report back to the Board within ~~120~~ 150 days with ~~an~~ the Early Education Expansion Plan and implementation framework that includes the above considerations, prioritized sites, timelines, and actionable steps to begin expansion of District programs and potential partnerships with community-based providers.